Stolt-Nielsen

NARRATIVE BRIEF · FOR DESIGNERS

RIPPL DESIGN SYSTEM · LANDING EXPERIENCE

One drop. Every product.



The story, the reason and the feeling behind Rippl: everything a designer needs to build a landing experience that makes every visitor think, oh yes, this is true.

Rippl: The Story Behind the Experience

Digital Innovation Centre · Version 1.0 · October 2026

Read this before you design a single pixel

We are building a landing experience for Rippl. Not a manual, not a component browser: a story the whole organisation walks through. This document gives you that story.

Rippl already exists as work: a Figma library, a Storybook repo, guidelines, trackers. What it does not yet have is a front door. The landing site is that front door, and a front door has one job: when someone steps through it, they should understand what this place is, why it matters, and why it matters **to them**.

So before layouts, before motion, before type scales, we align on the narrative. Every section you design should be able to answer one question: **which part of the story am I telling?** If a section cannot answer that, it does not belong on the site.

How to use this document

- **Sections 02 to 04** give you the heart: the feeling we are designing for, the world before Rippl, and what Rippl actually is.
- **Sections 05 and 06** give you the soul: the story behind the name and the reason the system matters.
- **Sections 07 and 08** give you the shape: how Rippl works in plain words, and the two verbs that carry its culture.
- **Section 09** is the spine of the site: the visitor's journey, act by act, with the feeling each act must create.
- **Sections 10 and 11** keep us honest: the voice we write in, and what this site must never become.

A NOTE ON THE REFERENCE

We are inspired by the craft of great brand sites: generous pacing, one idea per screen, scroll that feels like turning pages of a story. Take the discipline, not the content. Everything on our site comes from this document and from Rippl itself.

THE ONE RULE

Keep it simple. If a visitor needs design vocabulary to understand a section, rewrite the section. Rippl should be explainable to anyone at Stolt, from a deck officer to a developer, in the time it takes to drink a coffee.

"Oh yes, this is true."

That is the target. Not "this looks nice" and not "this is impressive". Recognition. The quiet nod of someone who has lived the problem and now sees it named.

Most internal launches ask people to believe in something new. Rippl is different: it asks people to **recognise something they already know**. Everyone at Stolt has seen the same screen look three different ways. Everyone has waited for a small change to crawl through five products. Everyone has wondered why the same button needs to be rebuilt again and again.

When the site puts that experience into words, the visitor does not need convincing. They supply the belief themselves. That is the psychology we are designing for: **we do not sell Rippl, we let people recognise it.**

> **Belief that is recognised lasts. Belief that is sold fades.**

The emotional arc, in one line

The visitor should move through four states, in this order:

STATE 1

Curiosity

"What is this? It feels calm and considered. I want to scroll."

STATE 2

Recognition

"Oh yes, this is true. I have lived this exact problem. They understand."

STATE 3

Belief

"This makes sense. One source, every product. Of course this is the way."

STATE 4

Belonging

"This is ours. I know what it asks of me, and I want to be part of it."

GUARDRAIL

If any section creates confusion, scepticism or the feeling of being lectured, it has broken the arc. Recognition first, always. Facts and features only ever arrive after the visitor already feels understood.

Every product was an island

Every good story needs a before. Ours is familiar to anyone who has shipped software here, and the site must tell it with honesty and warmth, never with blame.

Stolt builds many digital products, across businesses, across teams, across years. Each one was built with care. But each one was also built **alone**. Its own buttons. Its own colours. Its own way of saying the same thing. Nobody chose this: it is simply what happens when good teams work fast without a shared foundation.

What that world costs, in human terms

- **Designers rebuild instead of design.** The same table, the same form, the same card, drawn again for every product. Craft spent on repetition instead of on problems worth solving.
- **Developers translate instead of build.** Every handoff begins with questions that a shared language would have already answered.
- **Users relearn instead of flow.** A colleague moving between our products has to relearn patterns that should feel like home everywhere.
- **Change moves at the speed of the slowest product.** One small improvement has to be carried by hand into every island, one at a time. Most improvements never finish the trip.

> **Nothing was broken. Everything was separate. And separate is expensive.**

HOW THE SITE SHOULD TELL THIS

Tell it visually and gently: show sameness drifting apart, the one button that became five, the change that travels slowly across islands. Let the visitor feel the friction they already know. No charts of blame, no finger pointing at any team. The villain of this story is separation itself, never people.

This section of the site carries the heaviest emotional load. It is where "oh yes, this is true" happens. Give it room, give it quiet, and resist the urge to rush to the solution. The longer the visitor sits in recognition, the stronger the belief that follows.

What is Rippl?

Rippl is Stolt-Nielsen's design system: one shared foundation of building blocks, patterns and guidelines that every digital product draws from, built by DICe for every Stolt business.

Said even more simply: Rippl is **the single source every product trusts**. The colours, the type, the buttons, the tables, the patterns, the words, the rules of how things behave, all defined once, in one place, and used everywhere.

IT IS

A shared language

So every product speaks the same way, and every person instantly understands it.

IT IS

A living foundation

Maintained, versioned and growing. It improves continuously, and every product improves with it.

IT IS

A promise of sameness

The same action looks and behaves the same everywhere. Users carry their learning with them.

And what it is not

IT IS NOT

A restriction

It removes repetitive decisions, so teams spend their energy on the decisions that matter.

IT IS NOT

A one-time project

It has no end date. A design system is a product that serves products, for as long as we build.

IT IS NOT

Only for designers

Designers, developers, product owners, every DICer and every Stolt business builds on it.

THE ONE-SENTENCE VERSION FOR THE SITE

Rippl is the one place where Stolt's digital world is defined, so that every product is built once, built right and built the same.

On the site, this answer should land **after** the world-before section, never first. A definition means little until the visitor has felt the problem it solves. Context first, answer second: that is the order of the whole experience.

Why "Rippl"

The name is not decoration. It is the entire idea of the system compressed into five letters, and the site should treat it as a story worth telling slowly.

Ripple physics

Drop a single drop into still water and you do not get one change in one place. You get a ripple: a change that travels outward on its own, reaching every edge, touching everything, without being carried by hand.

That is exactly how the system works. **Change a token once, and every screen follows.** Fix a component once, and every product inherits the fix. Improve a pattern once, and the improvement travels everywhere the pattern lives. One drop at the centre, motion at every edge. The name is a physics lesson about how change should move through an organisation.

Rippl~~e~~

The missing E: ours to own, clean to trademark, impossible to confuse with anything else.

The missing E

We dropped the final letter deliberately. "Ripple" is a word the world owns. **"Rippl" is a word only we own.** It is distinct, searchable, protectable, and it signals intent: this is not a metaphor we borrowed, it is a name we made. The absence is the signature.

Where Rippl lives

Address	Role in the story
`rippl.stolt-nielsen.com`	**Home.** The landing experience this document briefs, and the front door to the system.
`gorippl.com`	The adoption movement: products and teams joining the system. See section 08.
`dorippl.com`	The contribution culture: people giving back to the system. See section 08.

HOW THE SITE SHOULD TELL THIS

Give the name its own moment: a quiet screen, a single drop, rings spreading on scroll, then the word with the E falling away. The one screen every visitor should remember.

Why Rippl exists

Not because design systems are fashionable. Because one organisation should feel like one organisation, everywhere its people meet it.

Four reasons, in order of importance

REASON 1

One Stolt, everywhere

Every product a Stolt colleague or customer touches should feel like it came from the same hands. Uniformity is not cosmetic: it is trust, made visible.

REASON 2

Change once, everywhere

Improvements should travel like ripples, not like cargo carried island to island. The system turns every fix into an organisation-wide fix.

REASON 3

Craft over repetition

When the foundation is shared, designers and developers stop rebuilding the known and start solving the new. Rippl buys back time for real problems.

REASON 4

Speed with confidence

Teams move faster when every building block is already decided, tested and trusted. Quality stops depending on who built which screen on which day.

The honest line on adoption

The site must be warm, but it must not be vague about this: **Rippl is the way we build now.** Adoption is not a menu option among many. There is one Figma library, one Storybook repo, one source of truth, and every product aligns to it. The tone is an invitation, the direction is certain.

> We are not asking whether to align. We are showing how good aligned feels.

HOW THE SITE SHOULD CARRY THIS

Confidence without threat. Say "this is how we build" the way a captain states a course: calmly, once, with no need to raise a voice. Pair every statement of certainty with a statement of support, so the visitor hears direction and help in the same breath.

How Rippl works

The site should explain the machinery the way you would explain it to a friend over coffee: three ideas, no jargon, no diagrams that need a legend.

Idea one: everything is defined once

At the centre of Rippl sits a single set of decisions: the colours, the type, the spacing, the components, the patterns, the words. Each decision is made once, written down once and stored in one place. There is no second copy anywhere to drift out of date.

Idea two: every product draws from the centre

Products do not copy from Rippl, they **connect** to it. Designers work from the shared Figma library. Developers build with the shared component code in Storybook. Guidelines explain how and when to use each piece. Because everyone draws from the same well, everyone's water tastes the same.

Idea three: change ripples outward

When the centre improves, every connected product improves with it. That is the whole trick, and it is why the name is the name. The system turns maintenance from a tour of islands into a single drop.

FOR DESIGNERS

One library

Open Figma, and everything you need is already there, already correct, already consistent.

FOR DEVELOPERS

One codebase of parts

Components arrive built, tested and documented. You assemble products, not parts.

FOR EVERYONE

One set of answers

Guidelines settle the debates before they start, so meetings are about problems, not pixels.

DEPTH LIMIT FOR THE SITE

This is as technical as the landing experience ever gets. No file structures, no token syntax, no repo screenshots, no process diagrams. Visitors who want depth will find it inside the system itself; the site's job is to make them want to look.

GoRippl and DoRippl

A system is a thing. A culture is a behaviour. Rippl comes with two verbs because we are building both, and the site should present them as the living part of the story.

VERB ONE · GORIPPL.COM

GoRippl

The adoption movement. When a product joins the system, it goes Rippl: it connects to the shared foundation and starts moving with everyone else. GoRippl is the journey every product takes from island to ecosystem.

VERB TWO · DORIPPL.COM

DoRippl

The contribution culture. The system is built by DICe, but it grows through everyone. When you improve a component, propose a pattern or report a gap, you do Rippl: you drop something into the water and the whole organisation feels the ring.

Together they complete the idea: **GoRippl brings products in, DoRippl makes people owners.** One is direction, the other is participation. A visitor should leave the site knowing which verb applies to them today, and that both will apply to them eventually.

Why this matters psychologically

Verbs turn an artefact into an identity. Nobody feels belonging toward a library, but people do feel belonging toward a movement they can act in. The two verbs are how the site converts belief (section 02, state three) into belonging (state four). They are the bridge from "this is true" to "this is ours".

HOW THE SITE SHOULD TELL THIS

Keep the two verbs side by side, equal in weight, late in the journey. By this point the visitor already believes; the verbs tell them what to do with that belief. Human language only: "your product joins", "your improvement travels", never "stakeholder onboarding" or "contribution workflow".

Seven acts, one scroll

This is the structure of the landing experience. Each act is one chapter of the scroll, with the message it carries, the feeling it must create and a sample line to set the tone. Build the site on this spine.

1

The drop · arrival

A still, calm opening. One drop, rings spreading, the name, the promise. No menus shouting, no feature lists. The visitor should exhale, slow down and want to scroll.

FEELING · CALM CURIOSITY

> "One drop. Every product."

2

The world before · recognition

The islands. The button that became five buttons. The change that travelled by hand and never arrived. Told gently, visually, with the honesty of section 03. This is the longest emotional beat; let it breathe.

FEELING · "OH YES, THIS IS TRUE"

> "Every product was built with care. Every product was built alone."

3

The idea · revelation

The turn of the story. What if everything was defined once? What if change moved like a ripple instead of like cargo? The solution arrives as relief, because the visitor has earned it by living act two.

FEELING · RELIEF, CLARITY

> "Change once. Rippl everywhere."

4

The name · meaning

The physics of the ripple and the missing E, exactly as told in section 05. The quiet signature moment of the site, and the screen people remember.

FEELING · DELIGHT IN THE DETAIL

> "Ripple is a word the world owns. Rippl is ours."

5

The world inside · substance

What lives in Rippl, in human words: the shared language, the living foundation, the promise of sameness. The three ideas of section 07, shown more than said. Enough substance to trust, never enough to drown.

FEELING · CONFIDENCE, TRUST

> "Everything you build with, decided once and done right."

6

The two verbs · belonging

GoRippl and DoRippl, side by side, as told in section 08. The visitor finds their own place in the movement: my product joins, my improvements travel, this is mine too.

FEELING · BELONGING, OWNERSHIP

> "Products GoRippl. People DoRippl."

7

The promise · invitation

The close. One Stolt, every product, one foundation, and a clear, single next step for each kind of visitor. End on certainty and warmth, the way the cover of this document begins.

FEELING · RESOLVE · "I'M IN"

> "One drop. Every product. Starting now."

Rules that hold the journey together

- **One idea per screen.** If a screen tells two things, split it or cut one.
- **The order is the argument.** Problem before solution, meaning before mechanics, belief before belonging. Do not reorder the acts.
- **Motion serves meaning.** Every animation should enact the story: rings spread, islands connect, change travels. Nothing moves for decoration alone.
- **Light, open, unhurried.** The experience is bright and generous, with room to breathe. Calm is part of the message: a system should feel like relief.
- **Scroll like a story.** Reveal as the visitor moves, so reading the site feels like watching the idea happen rather than studying a page.

How Rippl speaks

The copy carries half the experience. Rippl speaks like the best things we admire: clean, confident, human. Short sentences. Real words. No filler.

PRIMARY TAGLINE

One drop.
Every product.

WORKING TAGLINE

Change once.
Rippl everywhere.

Voice principles

- **Confident, never boastful.** State things plainly. "This is how we build" needs no exclamation mark.
- **Warm, never casual-for-effect.** We write like a trusted colleague, not like an advert.
- **Simple, never simplistic.** Short words for big ideas. If a sentence needs a comma map, cut it in half.
- **We and our, always.** Rippl is something we built together, not something issued to "users" by "the team".
- **Verbs over nouns.** Things happen in this story: change travels, products join, people contribute.

Words we use, words we avoid

Say	Instead of
One place, one source, the centre	Repository, single source of truth (as jargon)
Building blocks, parts, patterns	Assets, artefact inventory, UI kit
Your product joins	Stakeholder onboarding, migration rollout
Change travels, ripples	Propagation, downstream updates
DICers, colleagues, everyone at Stolt	Users, resources, team members

HOUSE STYLE, NON-NEGOTIABLE

No em-dashes anywhere: use commas, colons or full stops. Never the word "just". British-English spellings. Sentence-case headings. Keep every line scannable; if a paragraph takes more than ten seconds to read, it is two paragraphs.

Guardrails for the build

A short section with a long reach. Keeping the site small is how we keep the story big. These are the traps, named in advance so nobody falls into them.

NOT DOCUMENTATION

The landing site never becomes a manual. No component API pages, no token tables, no setup guides. The system itself holds the depth; the site holds the meaning. The moment reference content creeps in, the story drowns.

NOT A FEATURE LIST

We are not selling capabilities to a buyer. A grid of twelve feature cards would flatten the journey into a brochure. Every piece of substance arrives inside the story, in its act, in its order.

NOT A TROPHY CABINET

No stats walls, no logos of tools, no screenshots of trackers. The proof of Rippl is the feeling of coherence the visitor gets from the experience itself: the site must be the first product that visibly lives the system.

NOT LOUD

No countdowns, no confetti, no competing animations. The brand is a ripple, not a wave. Quiet confidence is the aesthetic and the argument at once.

The final test before anything ships

- Can a visitor who knows nothing about design finish the scroll and retell the story of Rippl in their own words?
- Did they feel "oh yes, this is true" before they were given a single fact?
- Does every screen know which act it belongs to?
- Would the site itself pass as a product built with Rippl's own care?

Four yeses, and the experience is ready. Anything less, and we return to this document before we return to the canvas.

RIPPL · BUILT BY DICE · FOR EVERY STOLT BUSINESS

Tell the story so well that nobody needs to be convinced.

They will recognise it, believe it and belong to it. That is the landing experience. One drop, and the rings do the rest.

Stolt-Nielsen